missed the most important developments of modern times.

He further contends that nations are not free to make and break alliances at will for power considerations alone. Even the 'balancer' is often not in a position to change sides whenever the distribution of power changes. The truth is that a nation selects its friends and foes depending upon its national interest, which may range from purely military-strategic to political, economic, cultural, and even psychological. It supports a nation as long as its national interest is best served from the preservation of the present international order and opposes those, who tend to disturb or seek a change in status quo.

Organski also points out that there is no such thing as a 'balancer' and never has been so. England, which was long thought to be playing a role of a balancer, actually was motivated by its self-interest and acted in world politics in such a way to uphold her preponderance of power, and not a balance at all.[15]

The other truth lies in the fact that balance of power does not ensure peace. On the contrary, almost all greatest wars recorded in modern history have occurred at times when one of the challengers balanced the preponderant power or when, through miscalculation, a challenger thought that its power was as great as that of its rivals.

Morgenthau[16] has forwarded a threefold criticism of the concept of balance of power. He has pointed out the uncertainty, unreality and inadequacy of the balance of power concept.

1. Uncertainty: Morgenthau points out that if balance of power is conceived mechanically, it would require an easily recognizable quantitative criterion by which the relative power of a number of nations can be measured and compared. It is only by means of such a criterion it can be ascertained that a particular nation tends to be more powerful than another or they tend to maintain a balance of power among themselves. But in reality, it is difficult to make quantitative measurement of power, and national power is composed of so many elements that the quality of these components is also subjected to constant change. Thus, rational calculation of the relative strength of several nations becomes a series of guesses, the correctness of which is doubtful. The uncertainty of power calculation